Design Brief: Onboarding and Home

How the first screens of the ADHD Budgeting App should look and feel, in plain words · AI Development Residency, Fall 2026

The problem

Adults with ADHD often quit budgeting apps during long setups, or lose track on busy screens. Every extra choice or distraction is a chance to leave.

Our answer

A short setup that gets people to their safe-to-spend number in minutes, then a home screen that shows that number first, with very little else on it.

Three design principles

1. **Simple beats rich:** if something doesn't help with the current task, it comes off the screen.
2. **Show value first:** people type in real numbers right away, with no feature tour.
3. **Calm, not pressure:** anything can be changed later or skipped for now.

Look and feel

- **Style:** calm and minimal, with lots of white space.
- **Voice:** a kind friend. Warm and relaxed, and it never judges.
- **Font:** Atkinson Hyperlegible, because its letters and numbers are hard to mix up. It may change later.
- **Dark mode:** included in this first version.

Colors

- **White:** the background on every screen
- **Deep blue #006E93:** all text and the main button
- **Teal #008F97:** shapes, icons and large numbers only, because it's too faint for small text
- **Cream #F8F2C8:** a small accent, never a full background

Never red for money.

Onboarding: 6 screens

1. Welcome: one line about the app, then "Get started"
2. Step 1 of 4: your balance
3. Step 2 of 4: your payday
4. Step 3 of 4: your bills, or "Skip for now"
5. Step 4 of 4: your savings, or "Skip for now"
6. "Your number is ready", then the home screen

Progress saves after every step, so people can leave and come back to the same place.

Home screen: one screen, no scrolling

1. The number in a sentence: "You can safely spend $245 until Friday", with a small "?" that explains it
2. Three buckets: Spending, Bills and Savings
3. One line for the next bill
4. A full-width "Add expense" button

How it behaves

- Buttons stay on. If something is missing, a gentle line says what's needed.
- Help is one short line beside a control, never a pop-up or tour.
- Moving from setup to home has one short, calm confirmation. With reduced motion on, it stays still.

Easy for everyone to use

- Text contrast of at least 4.5:1, and 3:1 for large text and icons
- Body text 16pt or larger, growing with the phone's text size
- Tap areas at least 44 by 44 points
- Labels for screen readers, and reduced motion respected

Design references

- **Loowner:** our main visual reference, for one idea per screen, big headlines, one full-width button and a segmented progress bar.
- **Copilot:** only its plain "left" wording, row of round budgets and "?" help. We skip its chart, tabs and stacked sections.

References are for inspiration only. Our screens are original.

Not in this version

Bank linking, goal picker, nickname, currency choice (it uses US dollars), weekly check-in, reminders and Focus Mode.

Sources: ADHD UX guidelines skill (Accessibility Checker, UXPA, Din Studio, Design Monks and iFactory; Spiel et al., CHI 2022; Bangma et al., PLOS ONE 2020); Loowner onboarding, via Refero; Copilot dashboard; Technical Requirements.

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